

Q. Discuss how the Government of India Act, 1858 and 1861 reflect the British response to the revolt of 1857 - not just as a political crisis but as an administrative reckoning?

→ The Government of India Act 1858 and Indian Council Act, 1861 passed by the British parliament after the revolt of 1857. It ended the rule of the East India company and transferred the administration of India directly to the British crown marking the beginning of the British Raj.

The Government of India Act, 1858 marked a decisive turning point in Indian history by ending the rule of the East India company and establishing direct governance by the British crown. Some key features are:—

- ① A new post, secretary of state for India, was created. responsible for Indian affairs assisted by 15 member council.

- ② The Governor-General of India was redesignated as the vice roy, representing the crown in India.
- ③ It ended the dual system of government and centralized authority in London.
- ④ It promise to respect the right of Indian prince and abolished the Doctrine of Lapse.
- ⑤ The Indian civil service were established theoretically allowing Indian to join through competitive exams.

The Indian Council Act, 1861 was enacted after Government of India Act, 1858 aimed to address demand for decentralization and Indian participation in colonial administration. Some feature of Indian Council Act are as follows:-

- ① Introduction of portfolio system where different member of executive council were assigned specific department [eg. Finance, home, revenue etc]

② Decentralization of legislative power

① provincial legislative council were established in Bombay and Madras, restoring some law making power taken away in 1833

② provincial council could pass law on local issue like education, land revenue, and public work but needed Governor-General

③ Nomination of Indian (limited)

① For the first time Indian were included in the legislative process though they were nominated not elected

~~④ Order~~

④ Beginning of Indian

Aspect	Significance
Decentralization	Restored provincial power
Administrative reform	Introduced portfolio system
Executive authority Representation	Began Indian inclusion in legislative council.

Aftermath of revolt of 1857 impacted British thinking about India. which led to a more cautious, and ultimately reached to conclusion subverting Indian voice may lead to another uprising. So British slowly included ^{Indian} in the ~~the~~ administration to subvert the future resistance by giving some independence in law making for example in Bombay and Madras, limited representation, abolition of East India company and beginning of crown rule etc.

Although, the limited power given in the GOI Act, 1858 and ICA, 1861 paved the way for later reform like ICA, 1892, 1909, 1919, 1935 etc. which gradually expanded Indian representation and legislative power. However Act of 1858 and 1861 addressed some of the grievance that led to the revolt of 1857 and so laid the early foundation for representation of India.